> War is not merely an act of policy but a true political instrument, a continuation of political intercourse, carried on by other means. . . . The political object is the goal, war is the means of reaching it, and means can never be considered in isolation from their purpose.[1]

Thus, the political goal takes precedence over military operations, and war serves as a means to a political end. From the beginning of the twentieth century, military thinkers have increasingly viewed war and politics as part of the same fabric differentiated mainly by the degree of violence. In this context, another Clausewitz dictum applies: "war is an act of force, and there is no logical limit to the application of that force."[2] Politics and war are intertwined, and in the conduct of war there can be an easy transition from one to the other, as for example, when incitement to hatred results in the type of unrestrained violence which may lead to genocide.

During the twentieth century, asymmetrical war has been waged on two tracks: political and military. Generally, the strategic objective of the party which wages this type of war is regime change, to be achieved by a combination of political and military means. For example, insurgents in China, Algeria, and Vietnam successfully practiced a modern form of war known as "people's war." Its guiding idea is that with time, the initiators will gradually make the transition from political war to hot war. The practice is to alternate between agitation, propaganda, negotiation, and violence, working with allies in the camp of the victim, and over a long time-frame endeavoring first to demoralize and paralyze the enemy, and subsequently to seize power using military force.

A weaker but well-organized protagonist initiates this type of war over an open time frame, conserving and augmenting its resources while preserving its existence. The first goal of People's War is to delegitimize the enemy and then to seize the victim's legitimacy for itself. Political propaganda is of major importance, and here is a remarkable convergence: delegitimization is the central method of political warfare and the central component of ideological anti-Zionism. For Israel's foes the political war is all about delegitimization.

Stefan Possony, the outstanding American strategist who pioneered the Strategic Defense Initiative, described the main tactics of people's war as follows:

1. The use of propaganda to deprive its enemy of its legitimacy and outside support: "*Propaganda, especially if it is attended by conquest, is the prime method through which* ***legitimacy*** [author's bold] *is withdrawn and attributed to a new power elite*."[3] In this context, propaganda has a special purpose: "As the war appears and

Copyright © 2016. Nebraska. All rights reserved.

Anti-Judaism, Antisemitism, and Delegitimizing Israel, Nebraska, 2016. ProQuest Ebook Central,